

Unit 10, Lesson 9: Writing Two-Step Equations from Real-World Contexts

Benchmark

MA.7.AR.2.2 Write and solve two-step equations in one variable within a mathematical context or real-world context, where all terms are rational numbers.

Learning Targets

- ☐ I can write two-step equations to represent real-world contexts.
- ☐ I can solve two-step equations within a real-world context.

10.9.1 Warm-Up: Bell Work

Tremaine solved the equation $-10 = -8.5 + 2x$ and checked his solution. His work and check are shown.

Work	Check
$\begin{array}{r} \frac{-10}{2} = -8.5 + \frac{2x}{2} \\ \hline -5 = -8.5 + x \\ +8.5 \quad +8.5 \\ \hline 3.5 = x \end{array}$	$\begin{array}{l} -10 = -8.5 + 2(3.5) \\ -10 = -8.5 + 7 \\ -10 \neq -1.5 \end{array}$

Tremaine knows his solution is incorrect, but he is not sure where he went wrong.

1. Explain how Tremaine knows his solution is incorrect.

2. Describe the error he made.

3. Find the correct solution to the equation $-10 = -8.5 + 2x$. Show your work.

10.9.2 Guided Instruction: Writing Two-Step Equations from Real-World Contexts

When writing equations to represent a real-world context, it is helpful to start by considering the known and unknown quantities involved in the situation.

1. Amanda is draining her pool for resurfacing. The pool began with 12,340 gallons of water and it is draining at a rate of 780 gallons per hour. How long has the pool been draining if currently there are 5,125 gallons in the pool?
- a. Complete the table to describe the known and unknown quantities in this situation.

Known Quantities	Unknown Quantities

- b. With your partner, discuss how the quantities are related in this situation.



When writing equations to represent real-world contexts, **any variables used must be defined** to identify which quantity each variable in the equation represents.

- c. Define the unknown quantity using a variable.
- d. Write an equation that could be used to find the unknown quantity using the variable you defined.

- e. Solve the equation.
- f. Explain what the solution means in this context.

2. Six friends met for a book club at a local coffee shop. Each person ordered a small cup of coffee and a muffin. The total for the order, including taxes, was \$37.56. If the cost of a small coffee is \$3.79 after taxes, find the cost of one muffin after taxes.

- a. Complete the table to describe the known and unknown quantities in this situation.

Known Quantities	Unknown Quantities

- b. Define the unknown quantity using a variable.
- c. Write an equation that could be used to find the unknown quantity using the variable defined.
- d. Solve the equation.
- e. Explain what the solution means in this context.

10.9.3 Try It: Writing Two-Step Equations from Real-World Contexts

1. The average toddler's height increases by 0.2 inches per month. Maurice's youngest brother James, who is a toddler, is 35.45 inches tall. If he grows at the average rate, how long will it take James to reach a height of 37 inches?
 - a. Define the unknown quantity using a variable.
 - b. Write an equation that could be used to find the unknown quantity using the variable defined.
 - c. Solve the equation.
 - d. Explain what the solution means in this context.

10.9.4 Guided Practice: Writing Two-Step Equations from Real-World Contexts Involving Percentages

1. Victoria works as a salesperson. She earns \$350 per week, plus 10% commission on her weekly sales. If Victoria needs to earn \$800 this week, determine how much she needs to sell this week.
 - a. Define the unknown quantity using a variable.
 - b. Write an equation that could be used to find the unknown quantity using the variable defined.
 - c. Solve the equation.
 - d. Explain what the solution means in this context.
2. Maddox has a coupon for \$10 off his purchase at Foot Zone. He found a pair of shoes he wants that is marked 20% off. If Maddox paid \$36.20 before taxes were applied, what was the original price of the shoes?
 - a. Define the unknown quantity using a variable.
 - b. What percentage of the original price of the shoes did Maddox pay?

-
- c. Write an equation that can be used to find the unknown quantity using the variable defined.
 - d. Solve the equation.
 - e. Explain what the solution means in this context.

10.9.5 Wrap-Up: Error Analysis

Mr. Humphries told his class he has some quarters and four dimes in his pocket, worth a total of \$2.40.

Devin wrote the equation $25x + 40 = 2.40$ to represent the situation.

1. Mr. Humphries told Devin his equation did not correctly represent the situation. Write an equation that correctly represents the situation.
2. If x represents the number of quarters, solve the equation you created in Question 1 to determine how many quarters Mr. Humphries has.